

KUTUMBA

Families Growing in Krishna Consciousness

Governance, Charter and Temple Relationship Framework

Adoption Draft — Version 1.0

A practical operating framework for a small family devotional cohort aligned with ISKCON and rooted primarily in Śrīla Prabhupāda's teachings.

Prepared for the founding cohort • June 2026

Document Control

Item	Current position
Document owner	KUTUMBA Program Director
Custodian	Documentation and Calendar Lead
Status	Adoption draft for founding-cohort and temple-relationship review
Version	1.0
Effective date	To be entered when adopted
Review cycle	After each learning cycle during the pilot; formally once each program year
Applies to	Leaders, volunteers, teachers, participating adults, children where age-appropriate, and invited guests
Related workstreams	Curriculum; children and safety; parent formation; prasāda and operations; worship; festivals; digital repository

Status of this framework

This document is complete enough to operate the founding pilot. It is not a substitute for the policies of a sponsoring temple, ISKCON authority, insurer, or applicable law. Where an external authority has jurisdiction, the stricter or controlling requirement applies.

Source and alignment

This framework operationalizes the KUTUMBA Master Operating Model and prior project decisions. It preserves the established identity, three-year destination, forty-active-week rhythm, KUTUMBA Setu pathway, role structure, source-control expectations, and temple-alignment boundaries.

The framework deliberately avoids creating a corporate-style board, member voting system, disciplinary bureaucracy, or independent ecclesiastical authority. The founding cohort is too small for that overhead, and KUTUMBA is not a temple or separate religious institution.

Interpretation rules

- “Must” indicates a binding KUTUMBA operating requirement.
- “Should” indicates the normal expectation; exceptions require a reasonable explanation.
- “May” indicates discretion within the stated boundaries.
- “Core Team” means the named role-holders responsible for program governance.
- “Family” includes the participating household members registered for the cohort.
- “Active week” means a scheduled KUTUMBA learning, festival, service, pilgrimage, or replacement activity.

Framework Map

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Operating philosophy

Use the lightest structure that reliably protects philosophy, people, children, temple relationships, money, and trust. Do not create a new rule because one conversation was uncomfortable. Create or revise a rule only when the risk is recurring, material, or difficult to manage consistently.

Part I — Identity, Charter and Operating Principles

1. Name and identity

The program name is KUTUMBA — Families Growing in Krishna Consciousness.

KUTUMBA is a small, structured family-formation and home-sādhana initiative rooted primarily in Śrīla Prabhupāda’s teachings and aligned with ISKCON. It exists to help participating families live, learn, worship, serve, and grow together.

2. What KUTUMBA is not

- It is not a temple, independent preaching center, or separate religious organization.
- It is not a replacement for temple participation, Bhakti-vṛkṣa, formal initiation procedures, or Bhakti Śāstrī.
- It does not confer initiation, promise initiation, certify spiritual advancement, or appoint gurus.
- It is not a casual social club, private political faction, therapy group, marriage-counseling service, or platform for personal followings.
- It does not speak on behalf of ISKCON or a local temple unless expressly authorized.

3. Vision

Vision

To cultivate families whose homes, relationships, habits, and service are increasingly centered on Kṛṣṇa.

4. Mission

Mission

KUTUMBA helps parents and children grow together through śravaṇam, kīrtanam, smaraṇam and mananam, arcanam and ācāra, sevā, sādhu-saṅga, utsava and yātrā, and responsible family care across generations.

The program joins philosophy with practical household worship, chanting, hearing, service, cleanliness, pilgrimage, festival participation, relationships, and family discipline. Weekly teaching is therefore one component of formation, not the entire program.

5. Six charter purposes

Purpose 1 — Establish Kṛṣṇa-centered homes

Help each participating family develop a practical home culture that includes chanting, hearing, offering food, prayer, worship, cleanliness, and service.

Purpose 2 — Provide systematic spiritual education

Teach sambandha, abhidheya, and prayojana progressively through Śrīla Prabhupāda’s books and authorized Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava teachings.

Purpose 3 — Develop devotional character

Cultivate humility, responsibility, truthfulness, compassion, discipline, cleanliness, punctuality, cooperation, and protection from Vaiṣṇava-aparādha.

Purpose 4 — Strengthen parents and children together

Parents do not outsource spiritual education to a weekly teacher. Children should see their parents learning, chanting, serving, apologizing, and improving alongside them.

Purpose 5 — Connect families with temple, festivals, service, and dhāma

Increase meaningful temple participation and create well-prepared opportunities for festivals, cow service, temple service, pilgrimages, and visits to sacred places in the proper mood.

Purpose 6 — Prepare participants for progressive commitment

Help participants become better prepared for stable personal sādhana, deeper service, gradual devotional-development pathways, formal Bhakti Śāstrī study, and—where appropriate—eventual initiation through the proper guru and ISKCON authorities.

6. Non-negotiable operating principles

Principle	Operational meaning
Kṛṣṇa remains at the center	Every outing, gathering, or social activity includes a clear devotional center such as kīrtana, japa, kathā, prayer, remembrance, or service.
No spiritual competition	Do not compare cooking, children, chanting, wealth, knowledge, singing, hosting, attendance, or service. Progress is reviewed privately against one's own prior practice.
No philosophical or ritual improvisation	Teachers and worship volunteers use approved sources and procedures. Attractive novelty is not authority.
No gossip or faction-building	Private weaknesses and temple controversies are not group entertainment. Concerns go only to a person who can responsibly address them.
No passive spectatorship	Every family gradually accepts suitable service after orientation and training.
No overloading	One principal KUTUMBA commitment per active week. Festivals and outings replace the regular gathering rather than becoming additional burdens.
Parents remain responsible	KUTUMBA supports family formation; it does not replace parental responsibility for children, home practice, conduct, or transportation.
Safety can stop an activity	The Children and Safety Lead may pause or stop an unsafe activity without waiting for group consensus.

Part II — Governance Structure and Decision Rights

7. Governance model

KUTUMBA uses a role-owned governance model. Routine work belongs to the person assigned to that function. The Core Team advises, reviews reserved decisions, and protects boundaries. Participating families are consulted on matters that materially affect them, but KUTUMBA is not governed by weekly voting.

8. Core Team roles

Role	Primary accountability	Non-delegable authority
Program Director	Overall coherence, calendar, leadership coordination, admission oversight, and implementation of adopted policy.	May make time-sensitive operational decisions within policy; cannot overrule a safety stop or independently remove a family.
Curriculum and Philosophy Lead	Three-year architecture, lesson approval, source integrity, teacher preparation, and correction of content.	May pause inaccurate teaching material; major doctrinal or worship changes require qualified review.
Children and Safety Lead	Safeguarding controls, volunteer clearance, supervision standards, incident response, and child-program readiness.	May immediately stop or modify any unsafe activity and escalate concerns outside the Core Team when required.
Operations and Prasāda Lead	Roster, facilities, food workflow, allergies, equipment, setup, cleanup, and operational continuity.	May cancel or simplify an activity when essential operational or food-safety controls are not available.
Kirtana and Worship Lead	Approved songs, worship sequence, instruments, training, altar readiness, and exact procedural review.	May stop unapproved worship practices or songs pending review.
Documentation and Calendar Lead	Version control, minutes, approved forms, calendar, family notices, and decision log.	Controls the official document version and publishes only approved materials.
Temple Liaison	Respectful communication with local temple representatives, calendar alignment, and escalation of temple-related questions.	No authority to promise temple endorsement; must accurately represent KUTUMBA's limited status.

9. Role concentration and minimum separation

One person may initially hold more than one role. The following separations remain mandatory even in a small cohort:

- A safety stop cannot be reversed by the Program Director. Restart requires the Children and Safety Lead's approval or the governing external safety authority's direction.
- A permanent membership removal cannot be decided by one person.
- Once pooled money begins, the person maintaining the ledger cannot be the only approver of their own expense.
- A complaint about a leader is handled by an uninvolved leader or external reviewer, not by the subject of the complaint.
- A teacher cannot be the sole reviewer of their own doctrinal correction or performance concern.

10. Decision classes

Class	Examples	Decision rule
Routine role decision	Weekly roster, room setup, lesson timing, supply purchase within approved budget.	Role owner decides and records only when others need the information.
Cross-functional decision	Calendar change, replacement activity, change affecting multiple teams.	Relevant role owners agree; Program Director resolves if policy already determines the outcome.
Reserved governance decision	Admission exception, removal, policy adoption, major annual-calendar change, unbudgeted major expense.	At least three uninvolved Core Team members review; decision requires a two-thirds majority of those eligible to decide.
Safety decision	Unsafe supervision, misconduct, medical concern, child-protection concern, transportation risk.	Children and Safety Lead or responsible adult acts immediately; review follows after risk is controlled.
Doctrinal or worship decision	New source, changed mantra, worship procedure, disputed philosophical statement.	Curriculum or Worship Lead pauses change; qualified ISKCON review is obtained when the issue exceeds existing approved guidance.
External representation	Use of temple name/logo, public statement, fundraising, outside speaker represented as endorsed.	Program Director and Temple Liaison approve; local temple permission is obtained where required.

11. Meetings and records

- The Core Team meets briefly at least once per active cycle and additionally when a reserved matter arises.
- Routine decisions do not require formal minutes. Reserved decisions require a dated decision note stating the issue, decision, owner, and review date.
- Sensitive personal details are not placed in general minutes or the Git repository.
- The Documentation Lead maintains the current charter, policy register, role roster, decision log, and annual review record.

12. Leadership conduct and accountability

- Leaders serve the program; they do not build personal followings or use access to control families.
- Leaders disclose conflicts of interest, relationships, financial interests, or personal disputes relevant to a decision.
- Leaders accept correction, do not retaliate against respectful concerns, and do not use spiritual language to silence disagreement.
- Leaders avoid promises they cannot authorize, especially regarding temple recognition, initiation, teaching status, or financial support.
- A leader may be coached, reassigned, paused, or removed from a role when reliability, conduct, doctrinal fidelity, or safety requires it.

Part III — Family Covenant and Participation Standards

13. Family covenant

Each participating adult signs the following covenant before full admission. Children receive an age-appropriate explanation rather than a legalistic signature process.

1. We will keep Kṛṣṇa at the center of KUTUMBA activities and will not treat the program as merely social entertainment.
2. We will respect Śrīla Prabhupāda’s teachings, authorized ISKCON standards, the approved curriculum, and the proper roles of guru, temple, and śāstra.
3. We will not present KUTUMBA as a temple, initiation pathway, accredited course, or independent authority.
4. We will participate as a family, accept suitable service after training, and avoid becoming passive consumers.
5. We will speak truthfully and respectfully, avoid gossip and faction-building, and take concerns to a person who can responsibly address them.
6. We will protect confidentiality while understanding that safety, abuse, legal duties, and serious misconduct cannot be kept secret.
7. We will follow child-safety, supervision, transportation, food, allergy, facility, and media-consent requirements.
8. We will arrive on time, communicate absences, and honor the work of volunteers and teachers.
9. We will not compare families, children, cooking, wealth, singing, knowledge, or spiritual practice.
10. We will not pressure another family to disclose private matters, adopt an unrealistic sādhana target, donate money, or follow a personal leader.
11. We will address conflict directly and privately when safe, accept mediation when needed, and avoid recruiting allies.
12. We understand that continued participation depends on conduct, safety, cooperation, and capacity—not only personal friendship.

14. Attendance expectations

KUTUMBA is a formation program, not a drop-in event. Consistency is required, while genuine family responsibilities, illness, travel, weather, and emergencies are handled with maturity.

- The normal annual target is participation in at least 80% of active weeks. This is an expectation, not a public ranking or automatic removal threshold.
- Families should notify the designated channel as early as practical when absent, and before the weekly headcount deadline when prasāda quantities or assigned service are affected.
- Three consecutive missed active weeks without communication trigger a private care and fit check.
- A family missing most of a cycle may be moved to inactive status and re-enter through the next cycle boundary or KUTUMBA Setu refresh.
- Attendance records are operational, not a measure of spiritual worth.

15. Punctuality expectations

- Families should arrive during the published arrival and setup window so worship begins on time.
- A late-arriving family enters quietly, avoids interrupting kīrtana or teaching, and does not expect the program to restart or repeat instructions.
- Repeated lateness that disrupts worship, teaching, child transitions, or assigned service is addressed privately with a practical support plan.
- Leaders and volunteers are held to a higher punctuality standard because others depend on their preparation.

16. Service participation

- The first month is demonstration and training; inexperienced families are not assigned unsupported ritual or safety-sensitive roles.
- Weeks five through eight normally use shadow service. Full rotation begins only after the responsible lead confirms readiness.
- Service assignments consider health, work constraints, skill, family capacity, and safety; they are not used to reward status or punish disagreement.
- A family that cannot perform an assignment must communicate early and help arrange the approved fallback rather than simply disappearing.

17. Home practice

Each family chooses one realistic weekly saṅkalpa or home practice. KUTUMBA may encourage, teach, and review patterns privately, but it does not police bedrooms, count rounds publicly, inspect homes, or pressure families to make declarations they cannot sustain.

Part IV — Admission, Trial, Withdrawal and Removal

18. Capacity and fit

The founding cohort is approximately five to six families. Capacity is determined by safe child supervision, teaching quality, meeting space, volunteer load, and the ability to care for families—not by pressure to expand quickly.

19. Founding-family admission

1. Introductory fit conversation covering program identity, family expectations, children, schedule, service, dietary issues, and temple relationship.
2. Review of the charter, covenant, privacy boundaries, and child-safety prerequisites.
3. Submission of required operational forms.
4. A mutual trial of four active weeks unless the Core Team records a different pilot arrangement.
5. Private review of fit, capacity, concerns, and any needed support plan.
6. Full admission confirmed in writing by the Program Director or delegated admission lead.

20. Later admission and KUTUMBA Setu

Later joiners should preferably enter at the beginning of a learning cycle. The core cohort does not restart when a new family arrives.

1. A prospective family may attend up to two sessions as observers, subject to capacity and safety requirements.
2. The family completes KUTUMBA Setu: orientation, foundational philosophy, devotional culture, and home practice.
3. A mentor family supports the newcomer without becoming a private authority over them.
4. The family remains provisional until the next suitable cycle boundary and completion review.
5. Full admission requires covenant acceptance, completed forms, realistic home practice, and no unresolved safety or conduct concern.

21. Reasons admission may be delayed or declined

- The group lacks safe capacity, appropriate age-band support, or required volunteers.
- The family seeks a casual drop-in social experience rather than the defined program.
- The family expects KUTUMBA to replace temple participation, provide initiation access, endorse a personal teacher, or modify core philosophy.
- Required safety, allergy, transportation, or conduct information is withheld.
- A current conflict, behavioral issue, or safeguarding concern cannot yet be managed safely.
- The scheduling commitment is clearly unrealistic for the family at that time.

A declined or delayed admission is communicated privately, respectfully, and without unnecessary detail. Friendship does not guarantee admission, and non-admission is not a declaration about spiritual worth.

22. Voluntary withdrawal

- A family may withdraw at any time. When practical, it should provide at least two weeks' notice so service, food, and child supervision can be adjusted.
- The family returns borrowed materials and resolves approved reimbursements or outstanding shared costs.
- Leaders offer a brief exit conversation but do not pressure the family to disclose private reasons.
- The group does not speculate publicly about the withdrawal. A simple operational notice is sufficient.
- Re-entry later may require a Setu refresh, current forms, and a new capacity review.

23. Progressive concern process

1. Private clarification: identify the specific behavior, impact, relevant covenant or policy, and desired correction.
2. Support plan: agree on practical steps, owner, and review date.
3. Written warning: used only when the concern is repeated, serious, or not corrected.
4. Temporary pause: used when participation must stop while safety, conduct, or fit is reviewed.
5. Permanent removal: a reserved decision made only after fair review, unless an external authority controls the outcome.

24. Immediate temporary pause

The Program Director, Children and Safety Lead, or responsible host may require a person or family to leave or pause participation immediately when necessary to control an active risk. Examples include violence, threats, intoxication, unsafe supervision, harassment, suspected abuse, dangerous transportation, severe disruption, or refusal to follow a direct safety instruction.

An immediate pause is protective, not a final judgment. The follow-up review occurs after immediate risk is controlled. Mandatory reporting, emergency services, temple procedures, or law-enforcement involvement are used when applicable.

25. Grounds for permanent removal

- Serious or repeated safety violations.
- Abuse, harassment, threats, violence, stalking, retaliation, or unlawful conduct connected with the program.
- Repeated gossip, faction-building, humiliation, or targeted disruption after correction.
- Persistent refusal to follow the covenant, approved curriculum, child-safety rules, or worship boundaries.
- Misrepresentation of KUTUMBA as temple-sponsored, initiation-authorizing, or independently authoritative.
- Financial dishonesty, theft, misuse of donations, or concealed conflicts of interest.
- Chronic non-participation or service unreliability when support and inactive status have not resolved the issue.
- Any condition that the Core Team reasonably concludes cannot be managed without disproportionate risk or harm to the small cohort.

26. Removal decision safeguards

- At least three uninvolved Core Team members review the matter; persons with conflicts recuse themselves.
- The affected adult receives the concern in understandable terms and a reasonable opportunity to respond, unless doing so would create further risk or violate an external process.
- The decision states whether it applies to one individual or the entire family, the effective date, return of property, communication boundaries, and any path to future reconsideration.
- The group receives only the minimum operational information needed. Details remain confidential.
- A single reconsideration request may be made within fourteen days on the basis of new information, procedural unfairness, or a material misunderstanding. It is reviewed by an uninvolved leader or external advisor.

Part V — Curriculum, Teachers and Source Authority

27. Curriculum authority

The approved three-year architecture is the controlling curriculum map. Detailed lessons are versioned. Teachers may adapt examples, questions, pacing, and age-appropriate activities, but they may not replace the assigned topic, contradict approved conclusions, or insert personal doctrines.

28. Source hierarchy

Priority	Source category	Use rule
1	Śrīla Prabhupāda’s published books and authorized teachings	Primary foundation for philosophy, practice, application, and quotations. Context must be preserved.
2	Official ISKCON/GBC standards and the controlling local-temple requirements	Control matters such as recognized institutional procedure, child protection, temple use, branding, and official programs.
3	Qualified guidance from authorized ISKCON teachers, pūjārīs, educators, or leaders	Used to clarify application, worship procedures, and disputed points within their competence.
4	Approved Bhakti Śāstrī, Bhakti Steps, or comparable authorized course materials	Useful for structure, definitions, study methods, and readiness—not a substitute for the original sources.
5	Teachings of recognized Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava ācāryas in the accepted disciplic line	May supplement after review; should not displace Śrīla Prabhupāda as KUTUMBA’s primary teaching foundation.
6	Educational research, stories, analogies, media, and secular skill resources	May support teaching method, family life, or communication. They carry no independent philosophical authority.

29. Prohibited curriculum practices

- Inventing philosophical conclusions from sentiment, dreams, private revelation, or social-media popularity.
- Using isolated quotations without context to shame families or settle personal disputes.
- Teaching confidential or advanced topics to children without curriculum approval and age-appropriate framing.
- Presenting personal preferences as universal ISKCON requirements.
- Changing mantras, worship sequences, āratī procedures, bhoga offerings, or Deity-worship standards without qualified authorization.
- Using copyrighted materials unlawfully or placing restricted texts, recordings, or scans in the repository.

30. Teacher eligibility

A KUTUMBA teacher is approved for a specific audience and scope. Approval is not a general title or spiritual rank.

- Demonstrates respectful conduct, reliability, humility, and willingness to be corrected.
- Understands the assigned material and can distinguish source teaching from personal opinion.
- Uses the facilitator guide and prepares before the session.
- Can teach interactively within the time limit and avoid unnecessary lectures.
- Completes required child-safety training before teaching minors and follows two-adult and visible-space controls.
- Does not use teaching access for counseling beyond competence, political campaigning, fundraising, recruitment into another group, or personal allegiance.
- Completes observation and shadow teaching before independent assignment, unless an experienced qualified teacher is specifically approved.

31. Teacher approval path

1. Application or nomination for a defined topic and audience.
2. Review of experience, source familiarity, conduct, and safeguarding status.
3. Observation of at least one session or sample teaching.
4. Shadow or co-teaching assignment.
5. Approval by the Curriculum Lead and relevant track lead.
6. First-session review and continued coaching.

32. Teacher review

Review area	Evidence
Source fidelity	Accurate use of approved sources; clear distinction between text, explanation, and personal example.
Learning quality	Clear outcomes, suitable questions, child/adult engagement, practical application, and reasonable pacing.
Devotional mood	Respectful speech, no competition, no humiliation, no self-promotion, and appropriate seriousness.
Boundaries	No private counseling, secret-keeping promises, political commentary, or unauthorized worship instruction.
Reliability	Preparation, punctuality, materials, communication, and completion of follow-up actions.
Safeguarding	Required supervision, visible spaces, age-appropriate content, and correct incident escalation.

During the founding year, active teachers receive a brief review after each cycle. Thereafter, formal approval is renewed annually, with additional review whenever a material concern arises.

33. Correction of teaching errors

- Minor errors are corrected privately and incorporated into the master lesson.
- A material error affecting the group is corrected clearly at the next reasonable opportunity without humiliating the teacher.
- Repeated or serious errors may result in required retraining, co-teaching, narrowed scope, or a pause from teaching.
- Disputed doctrinal issues are not debated indefinitely in front of families; they are documented and sent to a qualified reviewer.

Part VI — Temple Relationship and External Communication

34. Standard description

Approved description

KUTUMBA is a small family-formation and home-sādhana initiative that helps parents and children practice Śrīla Prabhupāda’s teachings and participate more meaningfully in temple life. It is aligned with ISKCON but is not a temple, separate organization, initiation pathway, or replacement for authorized courses and procedures.

35. Relationship objectives

- Increase, rather than reduce, meaningful participation in temple festivals, service, classes, and community life.
- Avoid calendar competition with major temple programs whenever reasonably possible.
- Seek qualified guidance for worship, philosophy, safeguarding, and matters that exceed KUTUMBA’s competence.
- Maintain accurate, respectful, low-drama communication with the local temple.
- Avoid creating expectations of endorsement, funding, facility access, leadership status, or initiation support that have not been granted.

36. Before launch

1. Provide the appropriate local temple representative with a concise one-page description, leadership contacts, planned calendar, and explicit non-competing identity.
2. Ask whether the temple has controlling policies for children, volunteers, facilities, branding, media, or outside programs that apply.
3. Request review of exact worship procedures or other matters needing qualified authorization.
4. Document what was approved, what was merely acknowledged, and what remains independent and unofficial.

37. Ongoing communication

- The Temple Liaison is the primary channel for routine temple-related communication.
- Provide a concise update at least twice per program year, or more often if requested, covering calendar, service participation, material changes, and concerns requiring guidance.
- Immediately communicate serious safety, conduct, facility, branding, or reputational matters when the temple has a legitimate role or duty.
- Do not copy large groups into sensitive disagreements. Use the narrowest competent channel.

38. Branding and public representation

- Do not use the ISKCON name, logo, temple logo, leader’s image, or wording that implies sponsorship without permission.
- Do not announce “official,” “authorized,” “temple program,” “certified,” or similar status unless that status is documented.
- KUTUMBA leaders may state their personal temple participation, but may not convert personal relationships into implied institutional endorsement.
- Public materials use the approved description and identify the program’s actual organizer and contact channel.

39. Initiation and guru-related boundaries

- KUTUMBA may teach the seriousness, qualifications, and gradual preparation associated with dīkṣā.
- KUTUMBA does not promise initiation, certify eligibility, select a guru for a participant, or bypass temple and guru procedures.
- Questions about formal recommendation, vows, waiting periods, or specific guru processes are referred to the relevant authorized authority.
- No leader uses KUTUMBA participation to pressure allegiance to a particular guru, faction, or personality.

40. Temple controversies and politics

- The Friday program is not used to debate temple personalities, elections, appointments, internal disputes, or rumor-based allegations.
- Families may ask sincere institutional questions privately. The Temple Liaison either provides a verified answer, identifies the proper authority, or states that the matter is unresolved.
- KUTUMBA does not mobilize families as a voting bloc, petition faction, fundraising bloc, or pressure group.
- Safety, abuse, misconduct, or legal concerns are not dismissed as “politics.” They are reported through the proper channel.

41. External speakers and partnerships

- Speakers are invited for a defined topic and are briefed on KUTUMBA’s audience, time, source standards, and child-safety boundaries.
- A guest’s fame, title, donation level, or personal relationship does not replace content and safety review.
- No outside group may recruit, fundraise, collect family data, or distribute unreviewed materials during KUTUMBA without approval.
- A speaker is not represented as temple-endorsed unless that endorsement exists.

Part VII — Conflict, Speech, Confidentiality and Devotee Care

42. Conflict-resolution principles

- Address behavior and impact, not motives or spiritual worth.
- Use the smallest circle capable of resolving the issue.
- Direct conversation is preferred when safe and appropriate; abuse, safety, harassment, or power-imbalance concerns may bypass it.
- No triangulation: do not recruit allies, forward private messages, or repeatedly retell a grievance to people without responsibility for resolution.
- Reconciliation may include apology, correction, restitution, changed boundaries, or a decision to separate peacefully. It does not always require restored closeness.

43. Conflict process

1. Pause and verify facts. Separate what was observed from assumptions and second-hand reports.
2. Private direct conversation, normally within seven days, using specific examples and a reasonable request.
3. Facilitated conversation with an agreed neutral KUTUMBA leader if direct conversation is unsuccessful or unsuitable.
4. Core Team review when the matter affects policy, safety, leadership, membership, or repeated conduct.
5. External mediation or temple guidance when the matter involves doctrine, temple relationship, serious power imbalance, or an unresolved complaint against leadership.
6. Written outcome stating agreements, boundaries, owners, and review date.

44. Anti-gossip policy

Practical test

Before sharing negative or private information, ask: Is this true enough to act on? Is the listener responsible for solving or reporting it? Is sharing necessary now? Would I say the same facts in a fair process? If not, do not share it.

Gossip includes repeating another family's weaknesses, marriage issues, children's behavior, finances, temple relationships, health, private practice, or alleged motives to a person who is not part of responsible care or resolution.

Permitted and required communication

- Reporting a safety, abuse, harassment, fraud, or legal concern to a competent authority.
- Seeking confidential guidance from the designated leader who can address the issue.
- Sharing necessary operational information on a need-to-know basis.
- Providing honest evidence in an authorized review process.

Prohibited conduct

- "Prayer requests" that unnecessarily reveal private details.
- Forwarding screenshots, voice notes, or allegations to build support.
- Publicly analyzing another person's sādhana, marriage, parenting, motives, or qualification.
- Using sarcasm, spiritual labels, or children's behavior to shame a family.
- Retaliating against a person who reports a concern in good faith.

45. Confidentiality rules

- Collect only information genuinely needed for safety, operations, communication, and lawful administration.
- Store sensitive family, child, medical, incident, and mentor information outside the Git repository and outside general group chats.
- Access is role-based and need-to-know. Curiosity is not a valid reason for access.
- Do not promise absolute secrecy. Safety, abuse, medical emergencies, legal obligations, fraud, and serious misconduct may require disclosure.
- Do not record meetings, classes, children, or private conversations without the required consent.
- Do not identify children publicly with full names, schedules, contact details, or private information.

46. Devotee-care boundaries

KUTUMBA leaders may listen, pray, offer scriptural encouragement, help a family identify practical next steps, and connect them with appropriate resources. They must not represent themselves as therapists, physicians, attorneys, licensed counselors, or authorized marriage advisers unless they actually hold that qualification and the role has been separately approved.

- No pressure to disclose trauma, marital details, finances, immigration status, health diagnoses, or private spiritual struggles.
- No closed-door or secret counseling relationship with a child or vulnerable adult.
- No diagnosis, treatment plan, medication advice, legal strategy, or promise that spiritual practice alone will solve a medical or psychological condition.
- Leaders refer out when a concern exceeds their competence and document only the minimum needed for continuity or safety.
- Mentor families support orientation and participation; they do not become confessors, controllers, or unofficial gurus.

47. Group communication channels

- One official announcement channel is used for calendar, attendance, service, and materials.
- Operational messages stay concise; philosophical disputes and personal conflicts are not conducted in the group chat.
- No forwarding of private family messages without permission, except for legitimate safety or reporting needs.
- No fundraising, sales, political campaigning, unrelated event promotion, or chain messages without approval.
- Quiet hours and expected response times may be published so families are not placed on continuous alert.

Part VIII — Volunteer Conduct and Operational Accountability

48. Volunteer eligibility

- Understands the assigned role and has completed the required orientation, shadowing, and safety steps.
- Is reliable enough that others can plan around the commitment.
- Follows role boundaries, approved procedures, and escalation paths.
- Discloses limitations, conflicts, allergies, medical restrictions relevant to the role, or inability to complete an assignment.
- For adult roles involving children, meets the current governing screening and training requirements before service begins.

49. Universal volunteer standards

- Treat every child and adult with dignity; no humiliation, threats, corporal punishment, discriminatory conduct, or retaliation.
- No intoxication or impairment while responsible for children, transportation, food, worship, money, or facilities.
- No private adult-child messaging, secret gifts, closed-door meetings, or transportation outside approved arrangements.
- No unauthorized access to family data, medical information, attendance, photos, finances, or incident records.
- No personal sales, recruiting, fundraising, or promotion through a service role.
- Report errors and incidents promptly; do not hide them to protect reputation.
- Return keys, equipment, files, and access when the role ends.

50. Role readiness and review

1. Observe the role.
2. Review the checklist and risks.
3. Shadow a trained volunteer.
4. Perform with supervision.
5. Receive approval for independent rotation.
6. Complete a brief review after the first independent assignment.

51. Volunteer concerns

Minor problems receive coaching. Repeated unreliability, boundary violations, hostility to correction, or unsafe conduct may lead to retraining, narrowed duties, temporary pause, or removal from service. Removal from a role does not automatically mean removal from KUTUMBA, but safety or conduct facts may require both.

52. Guests and visitors

- Guests are the responsibility of the inviting family unless the program assigns another host.
- Visitors receive a concise orientation to worship etiquette, children, food, photography, and confidentiality.
- Observation does not create permission to teach, supervise children, lead worship, collect data, or represent the program.
- Repeated attendance requires the formal admission pathway.

53. Incident and concern reporting

- Use the incident form for injuries, safety failures, boundary violations, threats, serious disruption, suspected abuse, transportation incidents, data exposure, or financial irregularity.
- Record facts, time, location, people present, immediate action, notifications, and next owner. Avoid speculation and labels.
- Emergency response and required reporting occur first; paperwork follows.
- Incident records are restricted and are not discussed in general meetings or group chats.

Part IX — Financial Governance for Future Use

54. Initial position: no pooled fund

KUTUMBA should not create a general pooled fund during the initial operating period unless recurring shared costs make it genuinely necessary. Families may bring assigned prasāda or supplies directly. The program tracks actual burdens for six to twelve months before designing a funding model.

55. Activation triggers

Formal financial controls activate when any of the following begins: recurring shared expenses, pooled contributions, reimbursements, ticketed events, donations, equipment ownership, facility payments, public fundraising, or money held on behalf of families.

56. Legal and representation boundaries

- Do not state or imply that contributions are tax-deductible unless a qualified sponsoring entity has formally accepted them.
- Avoid holding program money in an individual's ordinary personal account. Prefer an approved temple or legally suitable dedicated mechanism.
- Do not fundraise using the temple or ISKCON name without permission.
- Money does not purchase teaching influence, admission preference, leadership status, public recognition, or exceptions to policy.

57. Minimum controls once money is pooled

Control	Required practice
Written purpose	Each collection states what it is for, whether it is refundable, and who controls unused funds.
Budget	An annual or event budget is approved before commitments are made.
Receipts	Every reimbursement requires a receipt or documented exceptional approval.
Separation	No person approves their own expense. The ledger keeper and second approver are different people.
Thresholds	Budgeted expenses up to \$75: designated custodian. \$76–\$250: custodian plus Program Director. Above \$250 or unbudgeted: Core Team reserved decision.
Cash	Avoid cash. When unavoidable, two adults count it and sign the record.
Reporting	Provide a simple quarterly summary of opening balance, inflows, expenses, commitments, and closing balance.
Conflicts	Related-party purchases require disclosure, recusal, and two disinterested approvals.
Records	Keep ledger, approvals, receipts, and reconciliations for the period required by the sponsoring entity or applicable rules; use seven years as the default once formal funds exist unless directed otherwise.

58. Contributions and hardship

- Any family contribution model should be transparent, modest, and reviewed against actual cost.
- No child or family is publicly embarrassed for inability to contribute.
- Hardship adjustments are handled privately by two authorized leaders.
- In-kind contributions are valued as service, not used to create status competition.

59. Assets and closure

- Maintain a simple inventory for instruments, books, kitchen equipment, electronics, and other shared assets.
- Personal items loaned to KUTUMBA remain the owner's property unless donated in writing.
- If KUTUMBA closes, liabilities are settled first. Remaining pooled assets are transferred to the sponsoring entity or another qualified devotional nonprofit approved in advance; they are not divided among families or leaders.

Part X — Annual Review, Records and Change Control

60. Cycle review

During the founding pilot, the Core Team conducts a concise review after every active learning cycle. The review identifies what to continue, stop, simplify, correct, or defer. It does not reopen the entire charter unless evidence shows a real defect.

61. Annual review questions

Area	Questions
Mission fit	Did activities strengthen home sādhana, family participation, service, and temple connection—or drift into ordinary socializing?
Curriculum	Were sources accurate, lessons usable, age bands workable, and the program at least one completed cycle ahead?
Participation	Was attendance reasonably consistent? Were expectations realistic for working families?
Children and safety	Were controls followed? What incidents, near-misses, training gaps, or capacity limits appeared?
Culture	Did gossip, competition, politics, cliques, or leader-centered behavior emerge?
Operations	Was the workload fairly distributed? Were prasāda, setup, cleanup, and communication simple enough?
Temple relationship	Did KUTUMBA increase meaningful temple participation and maintain accurate boundaries?
Leadership	Were role owners reliable, correctable, and within scope? Is succession or redistribution needed?
Finances	Were costs transparent and necessary? Is a pooled fund actually justified?
Next year	What should be adopted, corrected, paused, or retired before the next cohort year?

62. Measures and reporting

- Use a small set of practical indicators: active-family retention, attendance pattern, service coverage, teacher readiness, safety compliance, cycle completion, temple/service participation, and family self-assessment of home practice.
- Do not publish spiritual rankings, rounds, confidential struggles, children’s comparative performance, or family-level “scores.”
- Qualitative feedback is summarized without identifying private comments unless consent is given or action requires identification.

63. Policy change control

Change type	Approval and notice
Editorial correction	Document owner corrects spelling, formatting, or non-substantive ambiguity; version note recorded.
Routine operating change	Relevant role owner and Program Director approve; families are notified before the change applies.
Material policy change	Core Team reserved decision; affected families normally receive at least fourteen days’ notice.
Major charter, identity, or governance change	Core Team reserved decision after family consultation and, where relevant, temple review.
Doctrinal, worship,	Controlling qualified or external authority is consulted; KUTUMBA does not self-authorize beyond

Change type	Approval and notice
safeguarding, or legal change	competence.

64. Versioning

- Every controlled document shows title, version, status, owner, effective date, and review date.
- Superseded versions are archived and marked obsolete; only one current family-facing version is published.
- Corrections to lessons and procedures are incorporated into the master repository rather than circulating indefinitely as chat messages.
- Private records and personal data are not committed to Git.

65. Records register

Record	Owner	Location / access
Current charter and policies	Documentation Lead	Controlled repository; family-facing approved copy in Drive/portal.
Role roster and training status	Program Director / Safety Lead	Restricted operational Drive.
Attendance and service roster	Operations Lead	Restricted operational system; minimum necessary access.
Family forms, allergies, emergency data	Safety / Operations Lead	Restricted, encrypted or access-controlled storage; never Git.
Incidents and complaints	Safety Lead or assigned reviewer	Highly restricted; retained per governing requirements.
Curriculum and teacher reviews	Curriculum Lead	Controlled repository for non-sensitive materials; restricted folder for personal reviews.
Financial ledger and receipts	Financial custodian	Restricted finance folder with second-approver access.
Decision log and annual review	Documentation Lead	Controlled governance folder; sensitive attachments separated.

Appendices — Forms, Templates and Checklists

How to use the appendices

These are minimum viable templates. Keep them short. Move detailed child-protection, medical, transportation, and legal forms into the dedicated safety workstream or the governing temple's approved forms rather than duplicating them here.

Appendix A — Family Fit Conversation

- ☐ Family name and participating household members
- ☐ Children's ages and any age-band or supervision needs
- ☐ Current connection to temple/community
- ☐ What the family expects from KUTUMBA
- ☐ Friday availability and realistic attendance pattern
- ☐ Willingness to participate in home practice and service
- ☐ Dietary, allergy, accessibility, transportation, or medical considerations relevant to participation
- ☐ Understanding that KUTUMBA is not a temple, initiation pathway, or Bhakti Śāstrī replacement
- ☐ Questions or concerns requiring follow-up
- ☐ Capacity/fit decision: proceed, delay, waitlist, decline

Decision owner: _____ Date: _____ Next step: _____

Appendix B — Family Covenant Acknowledgment

We have reviewed the KUTUMBA identity, family covenant, attendance expectations, communication rules, confidentiality limits, temple relationship, and child-safety prerequisites. We agree to participate within these boundaries and understand that participation may be paused or ended when safety, conduct, capacity, or program fit requires it.

Adult 1 name/signature: _____ Date: _____

Adult 2 name/signature: _____ Date: _____

Program representative: _____ Date: _____

Appendix C — KUTUMBA Setu Completion

Module	Completed	Notes / support needed
1. Orientation: identity, covenant, weekly flow, communication, safety	☐	
2. Foundations: body and soul, Kṛṣṇa, karma, chanting, guru-sādhu-śāstra	☐	
3. Devotional culture: kīrtana, āraṭi etiquette, prasāda, respectful speech	☐	
4. Home practice: chanting, reading, offering food, altar basics, service	☐	
Mentor-family conversation	☐	
Required forms current	☐	
Cycle-entry approval	☐	

Appendix D — Volunteer Role Agreement

- ☐ I understand the role, checklist, schedule, and escalation path.
- ☐ I have completed required orientation, shadowing, and safety steps.
- ☐ I will not exceed my authority, hide incidents, or use the role for personal promotion.
- ☐ I will protect confidential information and return access/materials when the role ends.
- ☐ I will communicate early when I cannot complete the assignment.

Volunteer: _____ Role: _____ Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Appendix E — Teacher Approval and Observation

Review item	Ready	Needs support	Notes
Source fidelity and topic understanding	☐	☐	
Clear outcomes and practical application	☐	☐	
Interactive method and time control	☐	☐	
Age-appropriate language and activities	☐	☐	
Devotional mood; no shame or competition	☐	☐	
Safeguarding and boundary compliance	☐	☐	
Preparation and reliability	☐	☐	

Decision: ☐ Approved ☐ Co-teach ☐ Retraining ☐ Not approved for this scope

Reviewer: _____ Teacher: _____ Topic/audience: _____ Date: _____

Appendix F — Concern or Incident Record

- ☐ Date, time, location, and activity
- ☐ Person reporting and contact information
- ☐ People directly involved and witnesses
- ☐ Observed facts in chronological order
- ☐ Immediate risk and action taken
- ☐ Emergency, parent, temple, insurer, or authority notifications
- ☐ Evidence preserved, if any
- ☐ Assigned owner and next review date
- ☐ Confidentiality classification and storage location

Do not delay urgent action to complete the form.

Call emergency services or follow mandatory reporting and governing safety procedures first. Record facts after immediate safety is addressed.

Appendix G — Conflict Facilitation Record

Field	Entry
Issue stated without motive labels	

Field	Entry
Facts agreed / facts disputed	
Relevant covenant or policy	
Each party's requested outcome	
Agreed correction, apology, restitution, or boundary	
Owner and due date	
Review date and escalation route	

Appendix H — Withdrawal / Inactive Status

- ☐ Effective date
- ☐ Voluntary withdrawal, temporary inactive status, or capacity pause
- ☐ Borrowed items returned
- ☐ Outstanding approved expenses resolved
- ☐ Data and communication access updated
- ☐ What may be shared with the group
- ☐ Conditions for possible re-entry

Appendix I — Suspension or Removal Decision

Required element	Record
Decision-makers and recusals	
Specific conduct / risk / policy	
Immediate protective action	
Opportunity to respond or reason it was not appropriate	
Decision and effective date	
Scope: individual or family	
Property, communication, and event boundaries	
Reconsideration route and deadline	
Minimum message to the group	

Appendix J — Expense and Reimbursement

- ☐ Purpose and budget line
- ☐ Vendor / payee
- ☐ Amount and date
- ☐ Receipt attached
- ☐ Requester is not sole approver

- ☐ Related-party conflict disclosed
- ☐ Approval threshold satisfied
- ☐ Payment method and ledger reference

Appendix K — Annual Review Scorecard

Domain	Continue	Correct	Stop / defer	Evidence / action
Mission and devotional center	☐	☐	☐	
Curriculum and teaching	☐	☐	☐	
Children and safety	☐	☐	☐	
Attendance and family load	☐	☐	☐	
Culture, gossip, competition, politics	☐	☐	☐	
Service and operations	☐	☐	☐	
Temple relationship	☐	☐	☐	
Leadership and succession	☐	☐	☐	
Finances and assets	☐	☐	☐	

Appendix L — Launch Governance Checklist

- ☐ Charter adopted and version published
- ☐ Core Team roles assigned with backups
- ☐ Safety stop authority explicitly confirmed
- ☐ Temple-relationship briefing completed
- ☐ Approved description and branding boundaries confirmed
- ☐ Family covenant and admission process ready
- ☐ Required family and child forms ready
- ☐ Volunteer and teacher approval records ready
- ☐ Curriculum source hierarchy and first-cycle lessons approved
- ☐ Official communication channel established
- ☐ Sensitive data storage separated from Git
- ☐ Incident and conflict escalation contacts confirmed
- ☐ No pooled fund unless controls are activated
- ☐ Cycle review date scheduled before launch

Adoption Record

The undersigned adopt this framework as the governing operating standard for the KUTUMBA founding pilot, subject to controlling temple, ISKCON, safeguarding, legal, and facility requirements. Adoption does not create a separate legal entity or confer religious authority beyond the responsibilities expressly described here.

Role	Name / signature	Date
Program Director		
Curriculum and Philosophy Lead		
Children and Safety Lead		
Operations and Prasāda Lead		
Kīrtana and Worship Lead		
Documentation and Calendar Lead		
Temple Liaison		

Recommended adoption sequence

1) Core Team line-by-line review. 2) Focused temple-relationship review. 3) Safety-workstream cross-check. 4) Founding-family orientation. 5) Adoption and publication of version 1.0. 6) First review after Cycle 1.